

Cubs Practice #1 — Coaches Quick Sheet

Tuesday | 6:30–8:00 PM | 90 Minutes

Goals: Lots of reps • Learn the players • Identify position candidates • Introduce coach pitch • Keep it fun & moving

6:30–6:38 | Welcome + Warm-Up

All Together

- Quick coach/player introductions
 - Team expectation: Cubs hustle everywhere
 - Ask who wants to try catcher
 - Dynamic warm-up: jog, high knees, butt kicks, shuffle, arm circles, short sprints
 - Keep it quick — no standing around
-

6:38–7:15 | 3-Station Evaluation Circuit

~4 players/station | ~11 min each + quick rotations

① Infield Triangle — P / 2B / 1B

Coach rolls/hits balls randomly to P or 2B → field → throw to 1B.

Rotate players through P, 2B and 1B every few reps.

Mix in:

- Routine grounders
- Left/right movement
- Slow rollers
- Pitcher comebackers
- Some imperfect throws for 1B to handle

LOOK FOR: Ground-ball skills • Range • Arm strength • Throwing accuracy • Who can reliably catch at 1B • Hustle

Keep reps coming quickly.

② Outfield / Pop-Ups

Start easy and progressively add movement:

- Ball directly to player
- Left/right
- Coming forward
- Over their head
- Mix in grounders → throw back to coach

LOOK FOR: Ball tracking • Confidence • Catching • Speed/range • Arm strength

③ Tee Hitting + Net

2 tees/nets if available — rapid rotations

Focus on simple mechanics:

Ready → Load → Step → Swing → Finish

- Lots of swings
- Make one correction at a time
- See if player improves after coaching

LOOK FOR: Swing mechanics • Bat speed • Balance • Contact • Coachability

7:15–7:20 | Water Break

7:20–7:52 | Coach-Pitch + Live Defense

Full field

- Keith coach pitches
- Rotate players through defensive positions
- ~5 hittable pitches per batter
- If struggling → easier pitch/front toss so every AB ends with a live ball
- ACs spread around field helping players understand where to go

LOOK FOR:

- Who knows where the play is?
- Who attacks the baseball?
- Who freezes/waits?

- Who can handle P / SS / 3B?
- Who catches throws at 1B?
- Who tracks balls in OF?
- Who communicates/hustles?
- Who adjusts after coaching?

Experiment with positions — we're learning the team, not setting a lineup.

7:52–7:57 | Team Competition

Ground Ball Challenge / Knockout

Field → set feet → accurate throw.

Clean play advances. Increase difficulty as we go.

Fast • Competitive • Fun

7:57–8:00 | Team Huddle

- Recognize hustle / good listening
- Quick praise for specific things we saw
- Reinforce: Cubs hustle everywhere
- Hands in → CUBS!

Potential Position Clues:

P / SS / 3B: Arm + fielding + awareness

1B: Reliable hands / catches imperfect throws

2B: Fielding + awareness

OF: Tracking + speed/range

C: Wants it + comfortable behind plate

Practice Rule: If kids are standing around waiting, adjust the drill. Reps, reps, reps.

Tonight we aren't picking positions — we're learning our team.